

To expand your customer base, you could go out and network in venues where you think that prospective customers would gather, or you can use your friends' network to expand your business base. You could also try out other methods like hosting a shopping party at your own home. There, you could spread the word around about the products you are selling by passing catalogues/ brochures etc.



Make the pitch. Close the deal

Typically, direct sales is also a game of patience since you would need to build a customer base over time through your own marketing efforts and also through referrals.

Before we dig deeper, know about the possible cons

Though direct sales is a practical method to generate income on your own, there are certain challenges that you would need to face in the process:

- Earnings from direct sales endeavors are always commission-based. This means that a percentage of income, which varies from firm to firm, from your sales would go to the company whose products you are selling. Check this before taking the plunge.
- Most companies would want you to invest in a starter kit before you could start selling their products. This initial investment may not be huge but still, if you are unable to sell off products (many of which might come with an expiry date) within a certain time-frame, you may end up incurring a loss on the starter kit.
- You also need to be wary of fraud companies
- Coming up with your own leads could be harder than you may imagine.



Know thy hurdles

The ideal candidate

The following mini-list is by no means exhaustive. But it does mention the common characteristics of those who are an ideal fit for direct sales:

- Determined personalities with an outgoing attitude are ideal for direct sales.